Opening narrative 开场 read aloud, lights low, title screen on, before the personal intros

Listen.

There is a river in the middle of China called the Han 汉江. In winter it runs grey and wide and slow, and for a thousand years it has been the line between north and south. On its two banks stand two walled cities, close enough that on a clear day a man on one wall can watch the sentries pace on the other: Fencewall 樊城 to the north, Southbright 襄阳 to the south. Between them, until last week, there was a bridge.

The year is 1268. The empire of the Song 宋 is old and gold and soft, and it has forgotten how to fight. Out of the north have come the Mongols, who have never forgotten. They have broken kingdoms from the Yellow Sea to the gates of Europe, and now their horses stand on the north bank of the Han, and their marshal, a man called Ashu 阿术 of the Uriankhai, has taken Fencewall in three days. The commander of the garrison hanged himself. The magistrate opened the gates. The bridge is gone. Across the water Southbright still holds, its watch-fires small and stubborn in the dark, and everyone in Fencewall who has somewhere else to be is looking at those fires and wondering how to reach them.

This is not a world of monsters. This is a world of people: of soldiers and merchants and officials, and of another kind of people who live in the cracks between them, in what is called the jianghu 江湖, the rivers and lakes. Wanderers. Swordsmen who owe nothing to the emperor and everything to their masters. People who can run up a wall and down the other side, who can put a finger on your neck and stop your arm, who carry old grudges and older swords. If you have seen a film where two fighters duel on the roof of a teahouse, you know them.

Three of those people are in Fencewall tonight.

One of you is a wanderer 游侠, young and fast and poor, with a sword that does not belong to you and a thing you did ten nights ago that the whole city is whispering about.

One of you is the heir to a great house of medicine 商贾, from the capital far to the south, who came north with a convoy and a father and will go home with neither.

One of you is a commissioner of the court 命官, born to one of the oldest families in the empire, sent here with five thousand men to save a city that has already fallen, and still carrying the wound that kept you from leaving with the rest.

None of you has met the others. Each of you has a reason to cross the river. Each of you has a secret you would rather keep.

It is the eleventh of January. There is no moon. The guards on the bank change at midnight, and for a few minutes nobody is watching the reeds east of the city, where a one-armed boatman has promised, for a price, to take passengers across.

And it is foggy. In midwinter. Over a river that has never, in anyone's memory, made fog in January.

Let's meet you.

Then round the table: each player gives their character's name and one visible detail. Then: "Ten nights earlier..." and the first intro.

公若渡河 · Session 0 GM Pack Crossing the Han · Call of Cthulhu 7e · for the GM only

Before the session 开场前

☐ Foundry: quit → GitHub Desktop Discard All → Pull → launch → Yes to re-import. Module v0.4.2 or later.

☐ TV: open the world, activate scene **0 · Crossing the Han**; the Banquet track should start (click once in the window if the browser blocks audio).

☐ Check each scene once: tokens on the map, grid opacity you like, music changes when you activate it.

☐ Print: 3 character sheets (pp1–3) + 3 secret handouts (pp4–6) of character-sheets.pdf; this pack.

☐ Dice: 2×d10 (percentile) per player, d8, d6, d4, d3 (d6 halved). Pencils, erasers.

☐ Read p1–2, p7–8, p12–16 of the PDF (done). Keep p50–52 open for stats, or use the card on p4 here.

☐ Decide: do the other two players step out during intros (book) or stay and listen (fine)?

Agenda 流程 (≈3 h)

0:00	Title screen on. Who are you, what is CoC, the one rule (10 min).
0:10	Players pick HO1/2/3. Read the three public blurbs; hand out sheets + secrets.
0:20	Personalise: names, looks, pharmacy name, wound, sword style. Practice roll each.
0:50	Intro HO1 · Banquet (12 min)
1:05	Intro HO2 · North Gate (12 min)
1:20	Intro HO3 · Magistracy (12 min)
1:35	Break
1:45	Night Crossing (45 min)
2:30	Coffin Shop, ginger, stop. Tease the Fencewall map.

Running the rules 主持要点

- **One rule.** d100 ⩽ skill. You only name the difficulty: Regular / Hard (½) / Extreme (⅕). Default Regular; Hard when it is wet, dark, guarded.
- **Fail = something happens.** Describe the problem, then offer: push (one re-roll, disaster on failure) or spend Luck 1:1. Never both.
- **Bonus/penalty die** instead of modifiers: roll two tens dice, keep better/worse. The book's "Spot −20" = one penalty die.
- **Opposed** (Stealth vs Spot): both roll, higher success level wins, tie → defender (or higher skill).
- **Combat:** DEX order; attacker rolls skill, defender Dodge or Fight Back; damage − armour; half max HP in one hit = Major Wound (CON or fall); 0 HP = dying.
- **SAN:** "0/1" = roll SAN; pass lose 0, fail lose 1. Only two SAN rolls tonight.
- **Keep it moving.** Intros are 12 minutes: one entrance, one problem, one escape. Say yes, pick a roll, move on.
- **Scenes & music** auto-switch when you activate a scene (Scenes tab → right-click → Activate). Move tokens by dragging; players may touch the TV.

Wording 用词

Southbright 襄阳 · Fencewall 樊城 · the Han River 汉江 · Marshal Ashu 阿术 · Duan Driftwood 段游衍 · Commander Fan 范天顺 (the general, hanged himself) · Magistrate Fan 范玉楼 (surrendered) · Niu the Archer 牛富 · Captain Liu 刘卿堂 · Doctor Yue 越南柯 · the Hermit of Mount Crag 山阳道人 · Stillwater 止水 · Rainmaster's Ink 雨师墨 · Lightness 轻功 (= Climb/Jump) · Acupoint Strike 点穴.

Dates 日期

Late 1267: HO2's convoy, HO3's breakout. 3 Jan 1268: Liu crosses with 800. 4 Jan: Fencewall surrenders. 10 Jan: victory banquet, HO1's strike. **11 Jan, midnight: Night Crossing.** 12–18 Jan: session 1.

Damage & wounds quick table

Sabre / sword	1D8 + DB	Bow	1D6 (+½DB), 30 m	Arrow in the fog	1D3
Fists	1D3 + DB	Throwing knife	1D4 + ½DB	Cold water	1D3 (CON fail)
Stillwater 止水	1D8 + DB, wound never heals	Acupoint Strike 点穴	1D3; opposed vs CON: stun 1D3 rounds or ignore armour	Major Wound	⩾ half max HP in one hit: CON or fall

If a player...

- **wants to fight the whole banquet:** let one round happen, then Duan's intervention; archers "would have" shot. HO1 escapes; Ashu lives. Say so plainly if needed: this is a prologue.
- **wants to save HO2's father:** no. Narrate it in the past tense; it already happened.
- **refuses to board the boat:** the fog thickens, the guard changes, another boat offers; the spine happens anyway.
- **attacks the spine:** Armour 4, one spine is HP 6; it withdraws when hurt. Nobody has died from heroism yet tonight.
- **asks who the Lady of the Han is:** a river goddess the fishermen pray to. Nothing more tonight.
- **asks about the dark sky at noon:** "nobody knows". Write down who asked.

Scene beats 场景节拍 every roll the book asks for, in order

1 · Banquet 庆功宴 — HO1 alone scene: The Victory Banquet

Open: Fencewall fell in three days. The Hermit 山阳道人 gives you Stillwater 止水 at dawn.

> “你年轻，能从千军万马里取一颗头。不为那个糊涂皇帝，为汉水两岸的百姓！”
> "You are young; you can take a head out of the middle of an army. Not for that muddle-headed emperor: for the people on the banks of the Han." If you succeed, bring the head to my grave at Tomb-Sweeping with plum wine, loquat wine, beef, a pig's head, two chickens and three sesame cakes. If not, wander, and come home when the Central Plains are at peace.

Getting in: **Disguise** or **Luck** at the gate; **Climb** / **Jump** over the wall. Patrols everywhere, no looting (Ashu's order).

The hall: roast meat, bowls the size of a palm, Song dancers. Ashu on the dais: huge, bearded, felt hat, soft armour, a sabre at hand. Duan 段游衍 one seat to his right. Magistrate Fan grovelling.

The strike: let the player describe it; no roll needed to reach him, or **Stealth** if they sneak. Ashu twists, the blade takes his shoulder, he kicks the table over and swings: **Dodge** or 1D4, a wound to the bone, max HP −1. *Ashu's wound will never heal: penalty die on all his rolls from now on.*

Guards close, bows drawn. One round: fight (Sword 75 vs soldier Dodge 40) or press Ashu again (he Fights Back, Sword 75 with a penalty die). Then Duan steps in:

> “谁敢放箭？元帅在此！元帅快走！有我在，这刺客休想伤你一根头发！天哪，元帅受伤了，快送元帅出去！”
> "Who dares shoot? The Marshal is right here! Marshal, go, go! While I stand here this assassin will not touch a hair of you! Heaven, the Marshal is wounded, get him out!"

Out: HO1 slips away in the chaos (**Stealth** or **Climb** if they want a roll). Hiding since. The bridge is cut, the bank guarded; money finds a boatman. → the reeds at midnight.

2 · North Gate 北门 — HO2 alone scene: Fencewall, the North Gate

Open: late 1267, the medicine convoy, father in front. Soldiers stop you: a Mongol who barely speaks Chinese (Toghan) and a Chinese general (Duan 段游衍) who does the talking.

> “这鞑子知道你们家有钱，不剥层皮不会放人。有什么值钱的，现在就献出来……”
> "This Tartar knows your house is rich. He won't let you go without skinning you. Whatever you have of value, offer it now, as a gift to the Khan and the Marshal..."

Whatever HO2 says, father goes forward alone and sends them to count stock. The clerks beg them to run. Then: a mist of blood, a head flung sideways. Carts roll over the stain until it is gone.

Run for the gate: **DEX**; fail = 1D3, a wound that never fully heals, max HP −1.

The gate under martial law: **Credit Rating** or **Persuade**. Claim court business → Niu the Archer 牛富 comes over (dark, lean, black bow). He tells them Commander Fan is hunting a thief in town, and promises help with anything.

Days pass (narrate): gossip of a scarred woman outlaw, a drunk monk, a watchman who is everywhere; the assault, Commander Fan's suicide, surrender, Niu arrested. The house is leaderless. → the reeds.

3 · Magistracy 衙署 — HO3 alone scene: Fencewall Magistracy

Open: named Commissioner, Captain Liu 刘卿堂 brings 5,000; ambushed, 800 break into Fencewall. Commander Fan's joyless dinner: Magistrate Fan, Lady Fan, Prefect Xu (fat, shiny), Niu (eyes like torches). Magistrate Fan walks you home, flattering, hinting: a warm winter, the river running strangely high.

Then: the assault. Fan orders you and Liu to Southbright at noon; your wound keeps you in bed. Liu crosses with the 800. Next day: uproar, the clear sky goes black without rain, servants scatter, Mongol cavalry ride into the compound seizing people.

Escape: **Stealth**, or **Luck (Hard)** with a plausible plan; fail = soldiers who arrest anyone suspicious. Fighting out is allowed (Sword 45 / Bow 75 vs horsemen); a failed fight = another wound.

Out: hiding in town; everything north of the river is Mongol. → the reeds.

4 · Night Crossing 汉江夜渡 — all scene: Night Crossing of the Han River

Midnight, 11 Jan 1268. No moon, fog, ten metres of sight, watch-fires on the bank, the guard changing. Reed Marsh east of Fencewall, reeds taller than a man. They arrive one by one: *let them meet in character; 10 minutes*. The boatman is late.

Spot Hidden: unlit boats offshore, other night-crossers. **Idea/INT**: midwinter midnight is not fog weather.

Boatman Wang 船夫王: hemp, straw hat, one arm, filthy towel. Hates Mongols and court alike. Volunteers: his arm (army cart); Commander Fan ("would suck the pus from a soldier's wound; the court sent him children; he hanged himself"); the fog (the Lady of the Han pities the drowned); the assassin (the whole town praises the nameless wanderer — watch HO1's face).

On the water: dead slow, no lamp. A shape ten metres ahead: **Spot Hidden, penalty die**. **Listen**: splitting planks, screams. **Spot**: the boat rocks, armed figures.

The spine: they light a lamp. A twenty-bushel boat run through by a tentacle-like spine, tip soft and curling, hide like iron, barbed; it crushes the hull to splinters in silence. **SAN 0/1**.

The bank hears. Archers: **Dodge** or an arrow 1D3. The boat sinks: **Swim**, fail = keep only three named possessions. **CON**, fail = 1D3 from the cold. Wang abandons them.

Rescue: two men and a woman swim out and drag them ashore; back lanes to a shop on Front Street. → Coffin Shop.

5 · Coffin Shop 棺材铺 — all scene: Winding Stream's Coffin Shop

Twins Tower 姜楼 (restless) and Loft Jiang 姜阁 (steady); Winding Stream 曲流, big, stern, attentive. Stove lit. They give: Doctor Yue 越南柯 sent them ("he calculated you'd meet disaster tonight"); nobody will ferry anyone now, you need your own strong boat and a boatman; the Mongols seized every boat, a great family or official may have one hidden; the spine: Winding Stream blames Chu shamans; Loft: *"If the Mongols want Southbright they must cross by water. With that thing in the river, can they?"*

Close: Winding Stream hands HO2 an oil-paper packet from Doctor Yue: glossy nut brittle. Taste: raw ginger disguised as candy. **Stop.** Switch to the title screen. Tease: next time, the Fencewall map and three action rounds a day, 12–18 January.

Day One 加时：第一日 optional extension, 60–90 min: 12 January, from the ginger candy to dawn on the 13th

Tell the players: action rounds 行动轮

From tomorrow each day has three rounds: **morning, noon, evening**. Going to one place and doing one thing there costs a round. Eating, going home to the Coffin Shop and the Wineshop are free. Front Street is full of patrols and wanted posters for HO1 (face drawn vague by Duan 段游衍). HO1 fails **Disguise** → lowest **Luck** in the party decides if a soldier looks twice → **DEX** to get away, round lost.

Night of the 11th — first Dream-Call 梦引 HO3 only, quietly

A familiar voice calls HO3's name in sleep. **POW**; fail = waves heaving, timbers snapping, people screaming. **SAN 1/1D3**. The others only see them wake badly.

Morning of the 12th — Coffin Shop by day scene: the Coffin Shop

Millet porridge, flatbread, pickles. Shopfront crammed with funeral goods; finished coffins stand open to dry their lacquer. **Spot Hidden**: hidden compartments in the coffin walls.

Winding Stream 曲流 tells: wartime, everyone needs a coffin; she made Commander Fan's 范天顺. Compartments hold the dead's belongings against thieves and rot; Magistrate Fan 范玉楼 asked for one too.

Planning: name the four districts only: Front Street (shops, HO2's pharmacy branch, playhouse), Back Street (Merchants' Hall where Duan lives, temple), the Magistracy quarter, the riverbank (docks, reed marsh). Whatever they pick for the morning: "you spend it on that; we pick it up next time." → noon.

Noon of the 12th — the Street Crossing 街口 scene: the Street Crossing

Junction of Front and Back Street; inn, tea stall; the execution ground. Packed crowd, a strange heavy mood. Today's dead man: white-haired, one arm missing, a spear through the throat hoisting the body into the air. **HO1 recognises the Hermit of Mount Crag 山阳道人.** His face is calm, as if he expected it. If the master mattered: **SAN 1/1D3**. Let the player sit with it.

> “兀良哈为报徒弟一剑之仇，上岘首山抓走年逾七十的山阳道人，也还他一刀。止水不过三尺，阿术一把斩马刀却能将人拦腰砍断。”
> "Ashu went up Mount Crag himself to pay the old man back for his pupil’s cut. Seventy years old. That little sword Stillwater is three feet long; the Marshal’s horse-cutter took him in half at the waist."

> “阿术要斩不肯投降的宋臣，包括还关在监牢里的牛富。幸亏小范大人投降得快。”
> "The Marshal will execute every Song officer who won’t surrender, Niu the Archer 牛富 in the gaol among them. Thank heaven the young Magistrate gave in fast, or it’d be us."

GM: Niu dies here at noon on the 15th unless rescued (p29). Next session's set-piece; today only plant the line.

Evening of the 12th — Doctor Yue 越南柯 calls

scene: the Coffin Shop

A wandering healer is chatting with Winding Stream: HO2's foster brother, the Hollow Physician. He fusses over everyone's health, HO2's most. Play the reunion. He gives:

Boats: two unsent letters by Prefect Xu 许德显: one to the Mongol camp offering surrender and his three pleasure-barges and five small boats; one to Governor Lü 吕文焕 in Southbright weeping loyalty. Stolen during a "consultation". Either ruins Xu; together, a lever for his boats.

The poison (Rainmaster's Ink 雨师墨): knows little; a local legend may be in the county gazetteer 地方志 (Library, next session). **Scar-faced woman:** a disaster, or a condemned criminal. **Commander Fan:** far-sighted, devoted to the people, executed a man for stealing lamp oil. (Said flat.)

Night of the 12th — second Dream-Call scene: Night Crossing, darkness up; HO3 + Liu

Gla'aki 格拉基 calls HO3 to the bank alone, with a lure of light. Read, then **SAN 1/1D3**:

> 你站在船头，脚下的水面波涛不宁。雾气遮天蔽日。水下黑色的团状物攀住船身，折断船舷和龙骨，击穿甲板。有什么东西自你脊椎后方穿胸而过。你低下头，伤口正滋滋往外冒着绿色的腐烂液体……
> "You stand at the bow. The water heaves. Fog hides the sky and the far bank. Something black and shapeless comes up under the boat, snaps gunwale and keel, punches through the deck. Then something comes through your spine from behind and out of your chest. You look down. The wound hisses, and what runs out is green and rotten..."

POW: success = awake at the water's edge; fail = already waist-deep in the Han. Silence, fog, a glow ahead; a few steps and the water is at the chest. The glow dips and strikes from behind: **Dodge** or 1D3.

The spine: black, scaled, barbed, same as last night. **Captain Liu 刘卿堂** appears on the bank, throws HO3 a rusty sword. **Spine: HP 10, DEX 50, Fighting 40, dmg 2+1D5, armour 4.** Beat it or drive it off. If HO3 is losing, Liu takes the hits; he does not die tonight.

Liu was pulled out by fishermen and knows nothing of what happened to his men; he came out looking for clues. Overjoyed; walks HO3 home; from now on goes wherever HO3 goes. *GM only: a red web-shaped mark on his back (he survived a spine on the 3rd). Never volunteer it.*

Stop

Dawn on the 13th, Liu at the Coffin Shop. Title screen. Tease: three rounds a day; Niu at noon on the 15th; Xu's boats; the gazetteer. They hold two leads (letters, compartments) and one ally.

NPC card 人物速查 from the module sheets; Niu's numbers are an estimate

Who	HP	Arm	DB	Skills	Weapons	Notes
兀良哈·阿术 Marshal Ashu STR 80 CON 80 SIZ 85 DEX 70 INT 75 POW 60	16	1	+1D6	Brawl 75, Sword 75, Dodge 70, Spot Hidden 60, Ride 80, Intimidate 70	马刀 Sabre 1D8 + DB; 拳脚 Fists 1D3 + DB	Wounded at the banquet: penalty die on every roll he makes from then on (Rainmaster's Ink 雨师墨). Not meant to die in session 0.
段游衍 Duan Driftwood STR 65 CON 65 SIZ 70 DEX 60 INT 70 POW 50	13	0	+1D4	Sword 70, Dodge 60, Spot Hidden 60, Fast Talk 60, Persuade 70, Library Use 50	剑 Sword 1D8 + DB	Serves the Mongols, loyal to nobody, likes HO1. Talks his way out of everything.
牛富 Niu the Archer STR 70 CON 70 SIZ 65 DEX 75 INT 60 POW 65	13	0	+1D4	Bow 85, Sword 65, Dodge 55, Spot Hidden 60, Intimidate 60	神臂弓 God-Arm Bow 1D8+2; 刀 Sabre 1D8 + DB	Stats are my estimate (none in the book). The God-Arm Bow 神臂弓 shoots 400 paces; it matters in the finale.
刘卿堂 Captain Liu STR 70 CON 70 SIZ 70 DEX 70 INT 60 POW 60	14	0	+1D4	Brawl 75, Axe 75, Dodge 60, Spot Hidden 55, Library Use 50	斧 Axe 1D8+2 + DB	HO3's friend; offstage in session 0 (crossed with 800 men on 3 Jan).
越南柯 Doctor Yue, the Hollow Physician STR 50 CON 55 SIZ 65 DEX 50 INT 75 POW 60	12	0	0	Sleight of Hand 75, Fast Talk 70, Spot Hidden 70, Dodge 40, Library Use 50, Charm 65	—	HO2's foster brother 越南柯; offstage in session 0, he sent the rescuers and the ginger.
蒙古士兵 Mongol soldier STR 60 CON 60 SIZ 70 DEX 45 INT 45 POW 50	12	2	+1D4	Brawl 40, Sword 40, Bow 45, Dodge 40, Spot Hidden 40	弯刀 Sabre 1D8 + DB; 弓 Bow 1D6; 拳脚 Fists 1D3 + DB	Leather + felt, armour 2. Patrols of 4–6. Not clever; they shout for help.
蒙古骑兵 Mongol horseman STR 60 CON 60 SIZ 70 DEX 45 INT 45 POW 50	12	2	+1D4	Brawl 45, Sword 45, Bow 45, Dodge 40, Ride 70	弯刀 Sabre 1D8 + DB; 弓 Bow 1D6	Same but mounted; Ride 70. Only in the Magistracy raid.
姜楼 Tower Jiang STR 65 CON 60 SIZ 65 DEX 60 INT 55 POW 55	12	0	+1D4	Swim 70, Brawl 65, Dodge 40, Climb 55	拳脚 Fists 1D3 + DB	Twin, restless; swims like a fish. Rescuer at the river.
姜阁 Loft Jiang STR 65 CON 60 SIZ 65 DEX 60 INT 55 POW 55	12	0	+1D4	Swim 70, Brawl 65, Dodge 40, Jump 65	拳脚 Fists 1D3 + DB	Twin, steady; the one who asks the smart question about the spine.
曲流 Winding Stream STR 70 CON 65 SIZ 70 DEX 65 INT 65 POW 60	13	0	+1D4	Brawl 70, Dodge 65, Jump 60, First Aid 60	大刀 Big blade 1D8 + DB	Owns the coffin shop; stern, attentive, killed her husband ten years ago (do not tell yet).
船夫王 Boatman Wang STR 50 CON 55 SIZ 60 DEX 50 INT 50 POW 45	11	0	0	Swim 60, Dodge 30, Natural World 40, Boat handling 驾船 60	—	One arm, hates both sides, talks about the Lady of the Han. Abandons the PCs when the arrows fly.
格拉基脊刺 Gla'aki's spine STR 200 CON 100 SIZ 450 DEX 50 INT 50 POW 300	6	4	—	Brawl 40	脊刺 Spine thrust 2+1D5	A single spine of something vast under the river. HP is "per spine". Armour 4. SAN 0/1. Do not fight it tonight: it sinks the boat and leaves.
不死仆从 Undying Servant STR 50 CON 105 SIZ 65 DEX 15 INT 50 POW 50	17	0	0	Brawl 40, Dodge 10	生前武器 Weapon from life 1D6 + DB	Not in session 0. Listed so you know what the river makes of the drowned. SAN 1/1D8. A hit on the spine scar kills it.